Sam Negus

Group work – Individual reflection

To make our final projects as successful, fun and enjoyable as possible, it is important to reflect on our aspirations for our group and what we expect from one another. You should first answer the questions below individually. Then, you will be asked to pair with others to discuss your answers.

1. Think about one or more group projects in your past that went very well, helped you learn and/or think in a new way, and encouraged you to participate. **What behaviors, circumstances, situations, etc. contributed to your learning and functioning well in those groups?**

Consistent and thorough communication, constructive feedback, assigning fair shares of workloads, setting time aside frequently to get together as a group.

- Clear goals

2. Think about one or more group projects in your past that did **not** go well, did **not** help you learn or think in a new way, did **not** encourage you to participate. **What behaviors, circumstances, situations, etc. hindered your learning and functioning in those groups?**

Lack of communication, group members affraid to offend each other with overly critical feedback, meeting in a distracting environment, working freely and not distributing work evenly.

3. What is important to make the group project in this class function as well as possible?

Being open-minded and giving everyone a chance to voice their ideas.

Staying in contact as a group and planning.

Being encouraging and helping others.

Adapted from University of Virginia, Center for Teaching Excellence through UW Madison, Madison Teaching and Learning Excellence (MTLE). Based on *Reaching for Higher Ground: Creating Purpose-driven, Principled & Powerful Groups*, by E. Franklin Dukes, Marina Piscolish, John Stephens. Book Surge, 2009.

Constructive and distructive behaviors - Individual reflection:

Consider the handout on constructive and destructive group behaviors. Think back at previous group work and discussions you have participated in.

Identify 1-2 constructive behaviors you tend to exhibit.

Cooperating, harmonizing

Identify 1-2 destructive behaviors you tend to exhibit.

Occasionally dominating or digressing.

What constructive behaviors in others are most helpful to you functioning well in a group?

Cooperating, clarifying, harmonizing, and process checking.

What destructive behaviors are most disruptive to your functioning in groups? Which ones do you tolerate?

For me, blocking, withdrawing, and rushing are the most disruptive.

I can tolerate discounting, digressing, and dominating.

Project proposal feedback

You will now take turns to "pitch" your project proposals to each other. Each student gets 3-5 min to describe their proposals. During this time, the other students should listen actively, with their full attention and without judgement.

After the student has presented, the other group members should give **positive** feedback on the proposal. Focus on the things you think are good and interesting about the proposal, the type of model, the data sets proposed etc. Essentially, what are interesting aspects of the proposal that you would like to include as part of the final project you design together? To help yourself, you can write down at least 2-3 points below (including the feedback from others). **Each student should submit a copy of their own sheet on Canvas.**

1. Student name: Shoujun : Minimizing "false positives" when catching cheaters in first person shooter video games.

   Feedback:
   - Problem is well thought out and computationally sound.
   - Elaborate variables and constraints that make sense considering the problem: (accuracy, reaction time) detecting video game cheaters, minimizing false positives.
   - May be harder to find data for this topic.

2. Student name: Judi : Minimize effort in pursuing a swing state during the election in order to win as many swing states as possible.

   Feedback:
   - Very relevant topic, understandable for everyone
   - Concise ideas for data accessing and visualization.
   - I was very intrigued by the objective: deciding which swing states to pursue in an election.

3. Student name: Sam (Reflecting on my own feedback) : Maximize team efficiency within constraints of player fatigue.

   Feedback:
   - Broad topic that can be easily tweaked to make more simple or complicated.
   - Lots of data that is easily accessible.
   - Kind of difficult for someone to understand if they aren't familiar with basketball.
   - Clearly established objective, variables, and constraints.